

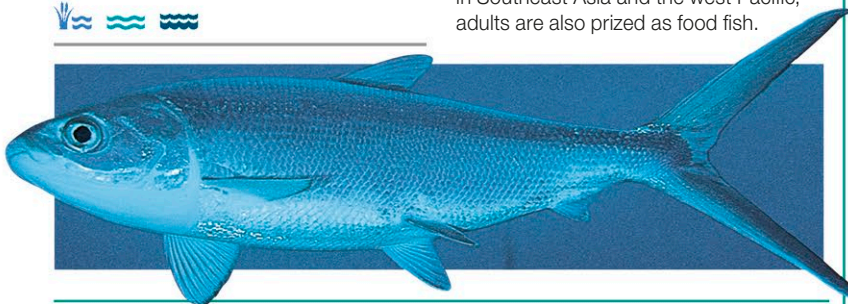
Chanos chanos

Milkfish



Length Up to 6 ft (1.8 m)
Weight Up to 31 lb (14 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location E. Pacific, North and South America, Indo-Pacific, Asia, Australia



Large and fast-moving, the milkfish has a streamlined silvery body and an unusually large, deeply forked tail. It can tolerate a wide range of salinity but spends most of its life in the sea, swimming up to 19 miles (30 km) offshore to spawn. The larvae and juveniles develop in warm, coastal wetlands, in brackish and freshwater environments. Milkfish larvae are collected and cultured in ponds for food in Southeast Asia and the west Pacific; adults are also prized as food fish.

Gonorhynchus gonorhynchus

Beaked sandfish



Length Up to 23½ in (60 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Atlantic, Indian Ocean, Pacific Ocean



This fish is adapted for life on the seabed, where it spends most of the daytime hiding in sand or mud, emerging at night to feed. Its upperside

is well camouflaged, and its eyes are protected from abrasion by a thin covering of skin. It has silvery flanks, and the tips of its anal and tail fins are tinged with orange or pink. Its dorsal fin is set far back on the body. The beaked sandfish is found on sandy shores across the Southern Hemisphere, at depths of up to 660 ft (200 m). It feeds on invertebrates that live on the seabed, and its small, downward-pointing mouth lacks teeth and is surrounded by small sensory flaps, or papillae, that help it find food. This fish is also called a beaked salmon but this is misleading because it is not a true salmon.

Cyprinus carpio

Common carp



Length Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
Weight Up to 82 lb (37 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Vulnerable

Location W. Europe to S.E. Asia



Originally from Europe and Asia, this deep-bodied, freshwater fish has been raised in semicaptivity for centuries, and introduced to rivers, lakes, and ponds in many parts of the world. It uses its protrusible mouth to grub through the bottom sediment for plant and animal food.

protrusible mouth



ORNAMENTAL CARP



Selective breeding has created different varieties of common carp over the centuries. Mirror carp have large scales, while leather carp have no scales at all. Leather carp are raised for food; the multicolored variety shown here is kept as an ornamental fish.

TOOTHLESS JAWS

The jaws of the common carp have no teeth. It grinds food with the pharyngeal teeth at the back of the throat.

Rhodeus amarus

Bitterling

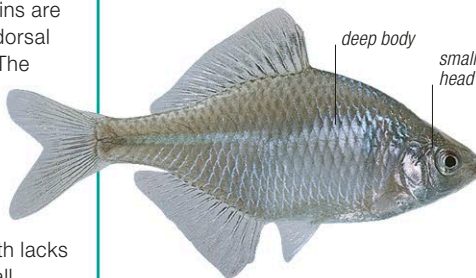


Length Up to 4¼ in (11 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location C. and E. Europe



This fish lives mostly in overgrown waterways with minimal water flow. The females are silvery, but during the breeding season the males become an iridescent silvery blue. Bitterlings have an unusual way of reproducing: using a long egg-tube, or ovipositor, the female lays her eggs in the mantle cavity of a freshwater mussel, over which the male sheds his sperm. The young grow in this "living nursery," without harming their host.



Myxocyprinus asiaticus

Chinese sucker



Length Up to 23½ in (60 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location China



This slow-moving, hump-backed fish is one of the few Asian species in the sucker family. It has protrusible, fleshy lips, which it uses to collect small animals from the riverbed mud. Its body

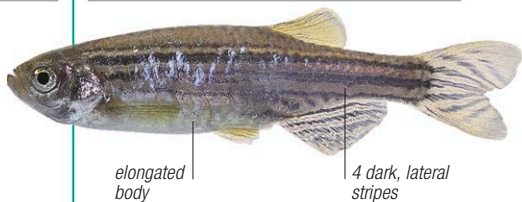
Brachydanio rerio

Zebrafish



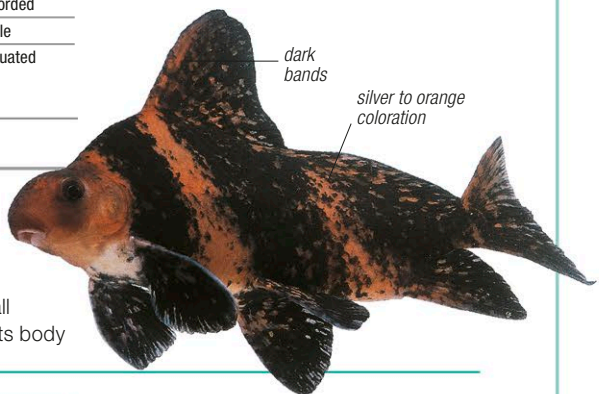
Length Up to 2¼ in (6 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location S. Asia



Also known as the zebra danio, this highly active, freshwater fish has a slender, silvery yellow body, with a characteristic pattern of 4 horizontal stripes running from its head to the tip of its tail. This tiny fish feeds on freshwater invertebrates, including worms, insect larvae, and crustaceans. The female is slightly larger than the male, and breeds by scattering her eggs in open water, or on the bottom of ponds and pools. Zebrafishes are widely used as a model organism in developmental biology. Several varieties of this popular aquarium fish have been created by breeders.

is triangular in cross section, with a pointed back, or hump, and a flat underside. It faces upstream to feed, so that the current pushes it against the riverbed—an adaptation that prevents it from being swept away.



Chromobotia macracanthus

Clown loach



Length Up to 12 in (30 cm)
Weight Up to 17 oz (470 g)
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Asia



A popular aquarium fish, the clown loach is a bottom feeder, feeling for aquatic invertebrates with the 4 pairs of barbels that hang down like a mustache from its mouth. Many

loaches—including this one—can defend themselves by raising a sharp spine in front of each eye. They use these spines against potential predators, and sometimes against each other. The clown loach spawns in fast-flowing rivers, at the onset of the rainy season.

